

Office of Strategic Workforce Development

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Fostering industry-driven training of in-demand skills and direct job placement

In **April 2022** (<https://www.governor.ny.gov/news/governor-hochul-announces-creation-new-york-state-office-strategic-workforce-development>), Governor Kathy Hochul announced an investment of \$350 million for workforce development, including the creation of the Office of Strategic Workforce Development (OSWD) within Empire State Development (ESD). This new division is charged with better aligning workforce development efforts with the needs and priorities of today's employers.



This investment represents a decisive shift toward a state workforce development strategy that is laser-focused on connecting New Yorkers to quality, in-demand jobs in the state's fastest-growing industries. Funding supports a \$150 million workforce development grant program, administered by OSWD, that will support employer-driven, high skilled workforce training programs.

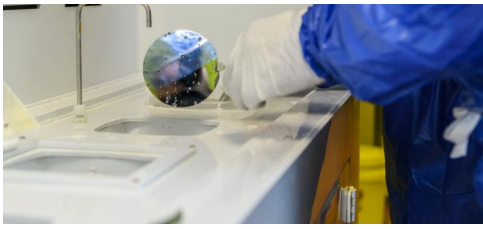
Investments are focused on statewide priority industry sectors. Through OSWD, ESD is helping to create new economic opportunities for unemployed, underemployed and underrepresented workers, while simultaneously meeting the labor needs of the state's highest-growth industry sectors.

Statewide Priority Industries

- Advanced Manufacturing and Materials



- Biotech and Life Sciences
- Cleantech and Renewable Energy
- Construction



- Construction
- Electronics and Optics, Photonics, and Imaging (OPI)
- Film and TV Production and Post-Production
- Software and Digital Media

Since formally launching in **2022** (<https://www.governor.ny.gov/news/governor-hochul-announces-launch-150-million-office-strategic-workforce-development-grant>), OSD has hit the ground running and has begun to lay the foundation for the State's new approach to workforce development, with combined awards totaling \$83 million to 91 workforce development projects across the state which will train more than 20,000 New Yorkers.

- **April 2026 – Fourth Annual Report Released** (<https://esd.ny.gov/esd-media-center/reports/office-strategic-workforce-development-annual-report-2026>)
- **March 2026 – Round 9 Awards Announced** (<https://www.governor.ny.gov/news/governor-hochul-announces-more-15-million-awarded-13-workforce-development-projects>)
- **July 2025 – Round 8 Awards Announced, Grant Applications Re-Opened** (<https://esd.ny.gov/esd-media-center/press-releases/governor-hochul-announces-nearly-5-million-awarded-six-workforce-development-projects-four-regions-nys-office-strategic-workforce-development>)
- **February 2025 – Third Annual Report Released** (<https://esd.ny.gov/esd-media-center/reports/office-strategic-workforce-development-annual-report-2025>)
- **December 2024 – Round 7 Awards Announced** (<https://esd.ny.gov/esd-media-center/press-releases/governor-hochul-announces-more-15-5-million-awarded-through-office-of-strategic-workforce-development>)
- **May 2024 – Rounds 5 & 6 Awards Announced** (<https://www.governor.ny.gov/news/governor-hochul-announces-more-87-million-awarded-through-office-strategic-workforce>)
- **February 2024 – Second Annual Report Released** (<https://esd.ny.gov/esd-media-center/press-releases/esd-releases-report-outlining-2023-accomplishments-office-strategic-workforce-development>)
- **November 2023 – Round 4 Awards Announced** (<https://www.governor.ny.gov/news/governor-hochul-announces-fourth-round-office-strategic-workforce-development-grant-awards>)
- **June 2023 – Round 3 Awards Announced** (<https://www.governor.ny.gov/news/governor-hochul-announces-third-round-office-strategic-workforce-development-grant-awards>)
- **April 2023 – First Progress Report Released** (<https://esd.ny.gov/esd-media-center/press-releases/esd-releases-report-outlining-first-year-accomplishments-office-strategic-workforce-development>)
- **March 2023 – Round 2 Awards Announced** (<https://www.governor.ny.gov/news/governor-hochul-announces-second-round-office-strategic-workforce-development-grant-awards>)
- **December 2022 – Round 1 Awards Announced** (<https://www.governor.ny.gov/news/governor-hochul-announces-first-ever-round-office-strategic-workforce-development-grant-awards>)

The success of the Governor's historic investment and of this Office depends on partnership and collaboration from numerous parties – employers and industries, workers and unions, workforce development providers and advocates, academic and philanthropic institutions, regional partners, and government agencies. OSD is committed to partnering with all stakeholders to advance its mission and have a transformative impact on New York State's workforce ecosystem.

Click here to view the OSD one-pager (<https://esd.ny.gov/sites/default/files/media/document/OSWD-Flyer-20240522.pdf>)

OSWD Workforce Development Grant Programs

OSWD manages two grant programs focused on creating and expanding industry-driven training that provides in-demand skills and direct job placements in specifically priority economic sectors that have been identified as high-growth throughout the state. Training programs must lead directly to employment in good jobs that pay minimally a living wage, allow for career and salary growth, provide economic security, and remove

the need for public assistance. OSD's programs also emphasize creating opportunities for underserved populations, including those not in the labor force, un/underemployed and low-income individuals, and which provide wraparound services to help get trainees to and through training.

Applications will be available for Round 10 of OSD's Workforce Capital and Pay for Performance Operating grant programs from June 1 to July 31, 2026.

After carefully reviewing the guidelines (see links below), applicants are encouraged to schedule an introductory meeting with OSD staff to evaluate eligibility prior to applying. Please reach out to workforce@esd.ny.gov (<mailto:workforce@esd.ny.gov>) to set up a meeting or with any questions.

Workforce Development Capital Grant Program

Provides funding for capital expenses related to new or expanding workforce training programs, including modernization of existing training centers, building new facilities, or to purchase machinery and/or equipment for training.

LEARN MORE ([HTTPS://ESD.NY.GOV/WORKFORCE-DEVELOPMENT-CAPITAL-GRANT-PROGRAM](https://esd.ny.gov/workforce-development-capital-grant-program))

Pay for Performance (P4P) Operating Grant Program

Provides funding that can be used for programmatic expenses related to new program development or expansion of an existing program, including curricula development, instruction and instructional materials, technology, marketing , and/or trainee supports.

LEARN MORE ([HTTPS://ESD.NY.GOV/PAY-PERFORMANCE-OPERATING-GRANT-PROGRAM](https://esd.ny.gov/pay-performance-operating-grant-program))

ON-RAMP Program

The \$200 million ON-RAMP Program will help fund and realize a network of four new workforce development centers in strategic, high impact locations in Upstate New York.

LEARN MORE([HTTPS://ESD.NY.GOV/ON-RAMP](https://esd.ny.gov/on-ramp))

Frequently Asked Questions

CLICK HERE ([HTTPS://ESD.NY.GOV/OSWD-GRANT-PROGRAMS-FREQUENTLY-ASKED-QUESTIONS](https://esd.ny.gov/oswd-grant-programs-frequently-asked-questions))

Workforce Development Best Practices

CLICK HERE([HTTPS://ESD.NY.GOV/WORKFORCE-DEVELOPMENT-BEST-PRACTICES](https://esd.ny.gov/workforce-development-best-practices))

Sign up for Email Alerts

Receive email updates about the Office of Strategic Workforce Development.

CLICK HERE ([HTTPS://EEPURL.COM/H-BDQT](https://eepurl.com/H-BDQT))

New York State's Workforce Development Investments

Find out more about New York State's investment in workforce development across state agencies.

LEARN MORE([HTTPS://WORKFORCEDEVELOPMENT.NY.GOV/](https://workforcedevelopment.ny.gov/))

Contact the Office of Strategic Workforce Development

Workforce@esd.ny.gov (<mailto:Workforce@esd.ny.gov>)

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(<https://esd.ny.gov/sites/default/files/media/document/Economic-Indicators-Dashboard-2026-4.pdf>)

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